UNEMPLOYMENT AND ITS AFFECTS ON EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT VISITS IN CALIFORNIA

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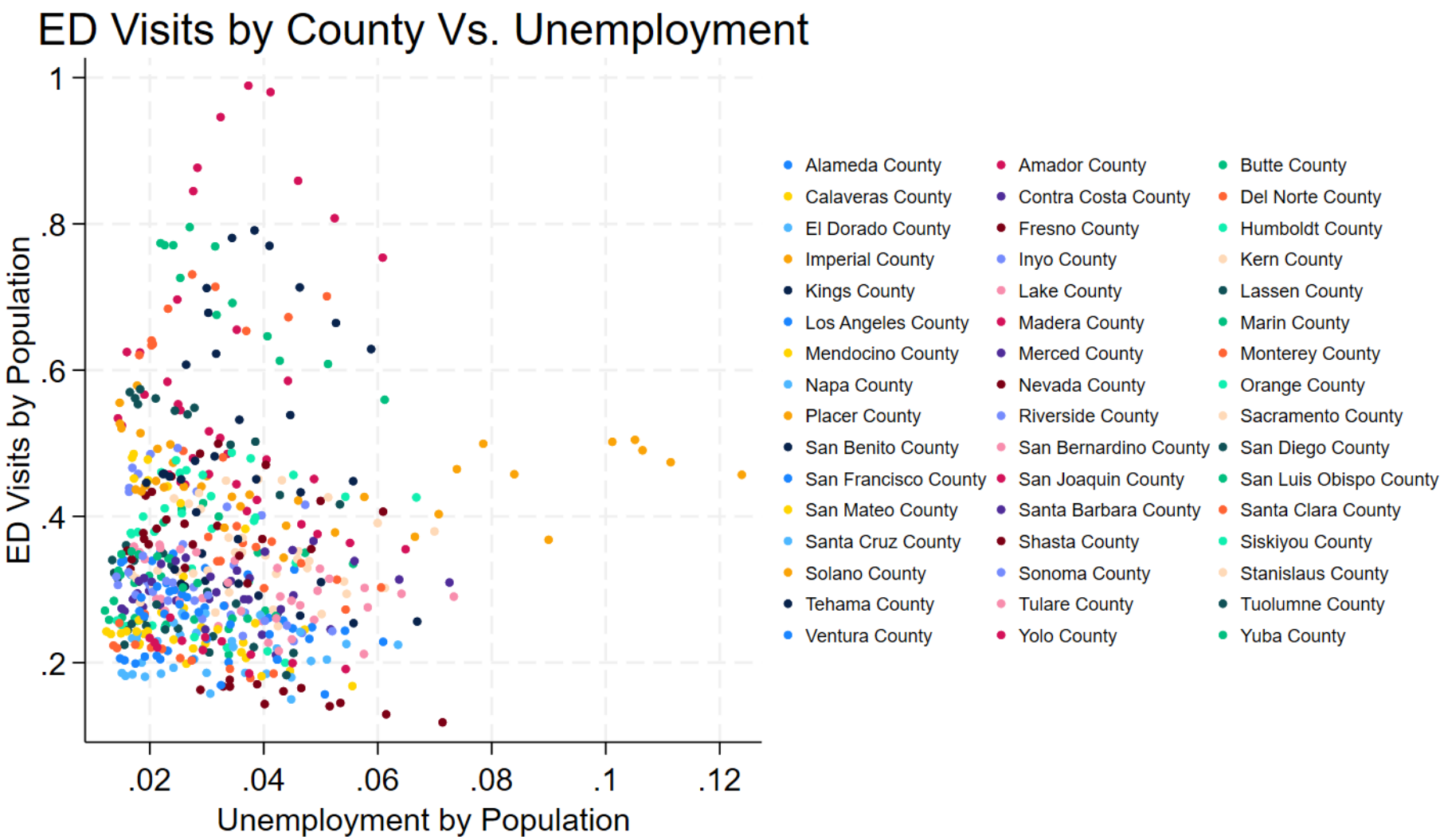
RESEARCH QUESTION AND PROJECT POSITIONING

- This paper aims to see if there is a causal relationship between the number of emergency department visits and unemployment.
- Data is sourced from BLS and CalHHS from 2012 to 2023.
- 48 California counties.
- Past research is nuanced, with some finding a correlation, while others feel more data is necessary.
- Help policy makers identify communities and/or racial groups needing more unemployment support.

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

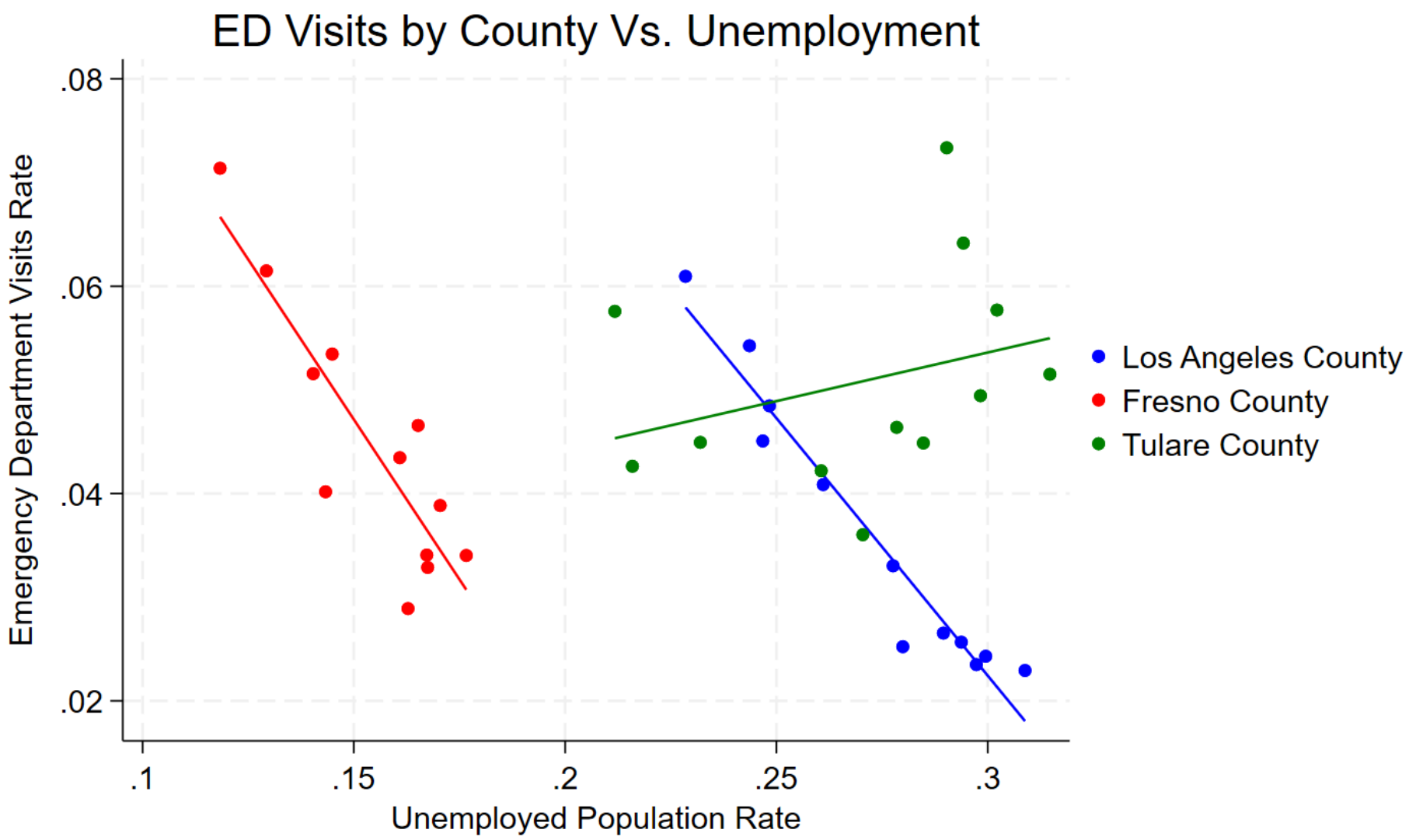
1. Standardized data and added per capita variables for unemployed and emergency department visits.
2. Created a scatter plot showing the upop vs. cpop for all 48 counties over the 11 years of data.
3. Ran a regression of cpop on upop to find the statistical significance.
4. Created scatter plot comparing 3 counties with varying industries.


ED Visits by County Vs. Unemployment
ED Visits by Population
1
.8
.6
.4
.2
.02
.04
.06
.08
.1
.12
Unemployment by Population
Alameda County
Amador County
Butte County
Calaveras County
Contra Costa County
Del Norte County
El Dorado County
Fresno County
Humboldt County
Imperial County
Inyo County
Kern County
Kings County
Lake County
Lassen County
Los Angeles County
Madera County
Marin County
Mendocino County
Merced County
Monterey County
Napa County
Nevada County
Orange County
Placer County
Riverside County
Sacramento County
San Benito County
San Bernardino County
San Diego County
San Francisco County
San Joaquin County
San Luis Obispo County
San Mateo County
Santa Barbara County
Santa Clara County
Santa Cruz County
Shasta County
Siskiyou County
Solano County
Sonoma County
Stanislaus County
Tehama County
Tulare County
Tuolumne County
Ventura County
Yolo County
Yuba County

	(1)
VARIABLES	cpop
upop	-1.557***
	(0.153)
Constant	0.405***
	(0.00523)
Observations	576
R-squared	0.924

Robust standard errors in parentheses

*** p<0.01, ** p<0.05, * p<0.1


ED Visits by County Vs. Unemployment
Emergency Department Visits Rate
.08
.06
.04
.02
.1
.15
.2
.25
.3
Unemployed Population Rate
Los Angeles County
Fresno County
Tulare County

CONCLUSION

- Dedicated support to communities with high manual labor, addressing unique challenges in physically demanding industries.
- Extend unemployment insurance to more, including those in smaller farms currently excluded from coverage.
- Enhance support to mitigate impacts of increased on-the-job injury and death risks that farm workers face.
- Recognize the seasonal nature of farm work, supporting workers who face frequent periods of unemployment throughout the year.
- Data is missing for 10 out of 58 counties and only extends back to 2012. This limitation means results could differ if data covering the 2008 financial crisis was available.